

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Why Multi-Agency Analytics Is Hard

The architectural challenge of scoping analytics across agencies in a shared tenant

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When This Applies

Multi-agency analytics is a challenge when your organisation meets **all** of the following conditions:

- **Single M365 tenant** — all agencies share one tenant
- **Multiple independent agencies** (or business units, divisions, departments) that operate semi-autonomously
- **Each agency needs Copilot analytics** scoped to their own population

The fundamental tension: Microsoft 365 Copilot analytics has several separately governed surfaces. In a shared tenant, there is no single partition or product setting that scopes the Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, metrics export, delegation, manager access, analyst queries, privileged roles, and downstream Power BI sharing together. A user with a tenant-wide access source can see “Your company” data even when an agency analyst is assigned only to an agency partition.

The patterns below coordinate those independent controls. They reduce accidental cross-agency reporting, but they do not create cryptographic, tenant, or product security isolation.

Single-Agency Tenants

If your tenant serves only one agency (or your agencies don't need separate analytics scoping), none of this applies. Follow the standard Admin Setup Guide instead.

The Two Architectures

THIS GUIDE'S AUTHOR-CREATED ARCHITECTURE PATTERNS

Default Priority and **Restricted Reporting** (formerly labelled “Isolation” in this guide and retained in existing URLs) are editorial names created by this guide. They are **not** Microsoft product, security, compliance, or licensing terms. Microsoft documents the component capabilities, including partitions; Microsoft does not document this guide's combined pattern as an end-to-end security boundary.

Default Priority is the simpler author-created option. An agency leader's “Your group” scope can follow their Entra ID manager hierarchy when Microsoft's access and hierarchy conditions are met (Microsoft does not state which scope the dashboard opens to, so confirm the landing scope in the tenant). The trade-off is intentional: a user with a tenant-wide access source may still use “Your company”, and a senior leader who has company-level access **and** is a manager chooses each delegate's scope: “Your group”, “Your company” or “Combined access”. Combined access includes the Consumption Dashboard, and a delegate with it sees exactly what the delegator sees. A delegate can't delegate further, the maximum is 75 delegates, and delegates must also be permitted to use the dashboard. If the delegator has both company-level and group access, existing “Your company” delegates automatically become Combined access and might see the Consumption Dashboard, so review delegate scopes. Choose this only when that visibility is accepted and documented. Setup typically takes 2–4 hours.

Restricted Reporting is the more controlled author-created option. It combines group-scoped Viva feature access management (VFAM), partition-scoped analyst query workspaces, restricted global access, and dedicated Power BI delivery. A partition limits the rows and columns available to an assigned analyst in that partition's query workspace; it does not govern every other Microsoft 365, Viva Insights, export, Agent, delegation, manager, admin, or Power BI surface. Treat the pattern as defense in depth and reporting segmentation. A regulatory, contractual, sovereign-cloud, or security requirement still needs a tenant-specific control assessment, Microsoft Support validation where behavior is unclear, and Compliance/Privacy/DPO approval. Setup typically takes 1–3 days.

Within Restricted Reporting, there are two data paths depending on whether agencies share an email domain:

- **Path A** — shared domain (e.g., all users are `@government.gov`). Requires organizational data with a custom `Agency` attribute to distinguish agencies. Refresh it whenever the source hierarchy changes.
- **Path B** — distinct domains (e.g., `@agencyA.gov`, `@agencyB.gov`). Uses the system-generated `Domain` attribute (derived from each user's primary SMTP address). No CSV needed for partitioning, though you may still want one for additional filter attributes.

Organizational Data Precedence Is Attribute- and Surface-Specific

Microsoft’s articles differ on whether a file upload replaces Entra data. The Copilot Dashboard article says an upload “permanently changes the source” of the dashboard data from Microsoft Entra ID to the file, including the Scope and Organization filters, while the parallel-ingestion article says Entra can remain the source for `ManagerId` and `Organization` . Do not describe either behaviour as universal; treat the tenant’s Organizational data page as the authority. Uploaded values change the source for supplied dashboard attributes; parallel ingestion can keep or restore Entra for `ManagerId` and `Organization` , while Microsoft 365 Profile has separate precedence. Before every change, record the current source for each required attribute in Data Quality/Profile, check **Setup → Migration and imports** plus Message Center, and use the upload path actually supported in the tenant. Microsoft’s upload articles currently describe a tenant-wave transition and differing legacy behavior.

Comparison at a Glance

Dimension	Default Priority	Restricted Reporting
Core principle	Agency CEOs can see their team through the “Your group” scope via manager hierarchy (landing scope: confirm in the tenant)	Partition-scoped analyst queries plus separate access and delivery controls
Cross-agency visibility	Possible — users can navigate to “Your company”	Reduced by surface-specific controls; residual tenant-wide and privileged access remains
Partitions needed	No	Yes — one per agency
Report delivery	Native Copilot Dashboard	Power BI workspaces (recommended)
PowerShell required	No	Yes (VFAM lockdown only; partitions are created via UI)
Setup effort	2–4 hours	1–3 days
Best for	Organisations where cross-agency visibility is acceptable	Organisations that accept defense-in-depth reporting segmentation after risk and compliance review

Surface-by-Actor Boundary Matrix

Actor and surface	What the pattern controls	Residual risk / required control

Agency leader or manager — Copilot Dashboard	Default Priority uses manager scope; Restricted Reporting can target the agency-user group with web-app/VFAM restrictions.	A shared executive or cross-agency manager hierarchy can span agencies. A tenant-wide access grant or eligible delegation can broaden scope. Test each role and account directly.
Agency analyst — advanced query workspace	The assigned partition limits available query rows and columns.	Wrong filters, overlapping membership, multiple partition assignments, or a conflict-of-interest analyst can broaden query access. The global partition remains tenant-wide.
Leader, delegate, manager, or analyst — Agent Dashboard, Consumption Dashboard, and metrics export	Separate feature/access policies may restrict entry. Consumption Dashboard access also follows global-partition membership, Manager settings and delegation scope. Identified (named-employee) outputs have their own VFAM policy.	Partitions do not scope these surfaces. Agent Dashboard and metrics export are previews with separate prerequisites and cloud availability; test all three independently. Copilot Analytics outputs are de-identified by default; Identification lets authorised users see named employees, so govern and test it separately. Microsoft's articles disagree on whether the Consumption Dashboard can be delegated: How to use the Consumption Dashboard says access can't currently be delegated, while Delegate access describes a Combined access scope that includes it. Test in the tenant before relying on either, and review existing delegates' scopes.
Report viewer — Power BI	Workspace/app audience, Viewer role, sharing settings, and optional row-level security govern report access.	Power BI permissions are independent of Viva partitions. Resharing, Build permission, export, Analyze in Excel, subscriptions, and copied files can leak data.

Global Administrator, globally assigned user, or global-partition analyst

Central governance can restrict assignment and apply least privilege.

These actors can retain tenant-wide visibility by design. Log, justify, review, and separately approve every global assignment.

Supported-Environment Gate

Stop Before Design If the Required Surface Is Unsupported

As of the dated Microsoft sources below, the Agent Dashboard is preview and its feature-specific article uses the conservative prerequisite of at least 50 Microsoft Copilot licences plus agent activity; a tenant with only 50 Viva Insights licences must validate availability. Agent Dashboard is unavailable in national and regional clouds. Copilot metrics export is preview. Microsoft's Supported environments matrix lists availability feature by feature for GCC Moderate (GCC-M) and GCC High (GCC-H). The Agent Dashboard, Copilot Dashboard metric export, the Consumption Dashboard and the Copilot Dashboard Readiness page are not available in either. Delegate access to dashboards is not available in GCC-M and is partial in GCC-H. Of the Copilot Power BI templates, only the Copilot business impact report is supported (GCC-M: yes; GCC-H: partial). Check the matrix for each feature before planning a government-cloud rollout. Microsoft's feature access management article states that its access controls aren't available in GCC High or DoD. For GCC, check the documentation for the specific app. Base Viva plan support does not establish feature parity. Validate the exact cloud, tenant UI, licences/service plans, Message Center, and required surface before implementation; escalate a documented mismatch to Microsoft Support.

Mandatory Go-Live Evidence Gate

1. Test a representative account for every actor: agency leader, cross-agency manager, shared executive, delegate, agency analyst, multi-partition analyst, global-partition analyst, report Viewer, Power BI Member/Contributor, AI Administrator, Insights Administrator, Insights Analyst, and Global Administrator.
2. For each account, run negative tests against the Copilot Dashboard, Analytics Reports, Agent Dashboard, Consumption Dashboard (including identified outputs), weekly/daily metrics export, advanced query workspace, query-result download, delegation, manager-published reports, Power BI workspace/app, report export, Analyze in Excel, and resharing.
3. Capture dated evidence: tester identity/role, group and partition memberships, VFAM/access policy export, org-data source and quality snapshot, expected denial, observed result, screenshot or audit record, Power BI permissions, test owner, and remediation ticket.
4. **Publication and go-live are vetoed if any negative test fails or cannot be executed.** Remove access or roll back the change, preserve evidence, and open Microsoft Support when documented behavior and tenant behavior differ.
5. Obtain written Security, Compliance/Legal, Privacy/DPO, Viva Insights owner, and Power BI owner sign-off on the tested behavior and residual risks. Product documentation alone is not an attestation.

6. Repeat the full test quarterly and after any role, manager hierarchy, delegation, org-data, partition, VFAM, licence, cloud, preview-status, or Power BI sharing change.

Rollback and Change Control

Record the current policies, access lists, role assignments, partition filters/analysts, org-data source/quality, query assets, and Power BI permissions before change. Use a test cohort first. Treat enabling partitions as a high-impact tenant change; Microsoft documents Support involvement to turn partitions off, and deletion can remove partition configuration and associated assets. For org-data changes, use supported update/delete behavior rather than dummy rows. Define an owner, maintenance window, success criteria, failure criteria, restoration sequence, approvers, and Support trigger before execution.

Ready to Decide?

If cross-agency dashboard visibility is accepted, evaluate Default Priority. If the organisation needs stronger reporting segmentation, evaluate Restricted Reporting, then determine the data path based on whether agencies share an email domain. If the requirement is cryptographic, tenant, or independently certified security isolation, neither author-created pattern establishes it; use a security architecture assessment to select an appropriate boundary.

[Use the Architecture Decision tool →](#)

Dated Microsoft Source Basis

Validated 2 October 2026 against: Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers (last updated 29 September 2026); Connect to the Agent Dashboard (2 September 2026); Supported Microsoft 365 environments for Viva Insights features (30 September 2026); Roles in Viva Insights (7 July 2026); Delegate access to the Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Copilot insights (16 September 2026); Configure manager settings (23 July 2026); Partitions in Viva Insights (14 September 2026); and Use your organizational data in Microsoft 365 and Microsoft Viva (1 September 2026). Check current Learn, Message Center, tenant UI, and Service Health before relying on any procedure.